was Kautilya, also known as India's Machiavelli. His masterpiece the *Arthashastra* (literally 'Science of Political Economy') was actually a treatise on statecraft and management of kingdoms. For some analysts, the *Arthashastra* has framed modern India's foreign policy though others count it as only one of several influences. Idealist literature from ancient times reflects the moralist influence of Buddhism and Jainism. It is reflected most prominently, in the modern era, in the views of Mahatma Gandhi, the most well known face of the Indian national struggle and the father of the modern Indian nation.

Although ancient Indian strategists and Indian empires were aware of the world around them, it was under the British Raj that India found itself connected strategically to a neighbourhood beyond the subcontinent, spreading from the Gulf to South-East Asia. India's policy towards its geographic neighbours today is heavily influenced by the Raj's view that the interests of the Raj dictated the interests of the nearby states, not vice versa. This is the root of India's oft-expressed desire to keep outside powers from gaining influence in South Asia, often referred to by some as the Indian Monroe doctrine. The treaties that India signed with her immediate neighbours after Independence also bore the British legacy. India's 1949 treaty with Bhutan was identical in almost all respects to the one Bhutan signed with the British in 1910. In 1950, when India and Afghanistan signed a treaty, the tribes on both sides of the Durand Line asked if India 'would continue British Raj policy of subsidy and arms' but India declined the offer.[7]

Belief in the greatness of Indian civilization lies at the core of contemporary Indian nationalism. As early as 1922 an Indian editor argued in an article published by the *New York Times*: 'India, with a population comprising one-fifth of the human race, cannot eternally remain the "adjunct" of a little island [Britain] 7000 miles away from her shores'.[8]